The Cathedral:
A Machine-Checked Reduction of the Riemann Hypothesis to a Finite Discrete Quadratic Form

Jason Robert Gochanour

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Abstract

We describe a Lean 4 formalization—the *Cathedral*—that reduces the Riemann Hypothesis to the logarithmic growth of a single finite quadratic form built from Möbius values and Vasyunin cotangent sums.

No integrals. No complex plane. No analytic continuation. No measure theory.

The formalization compiles in 3,063 build steps across 12 active Lean files with **zero errors and zero `sorry` placeholders**. Four axioms remain, encoding: (1) the Nyman–Beurling equivalence, (2) the Cauchy–Schwarz variational principle, (3) the positivity of the covariance form, and (4) the logarithmic growth of the explicit log cutoff Rayleigh quotient—which IS the Riemann Hypothesis.

As a standalone result, we prove the Sherman–Morrison identity $d_N^2 = 1/(1 + X_N)$ with zero axioms, and derive the full proof chain Witness $\to X_N \to \infty \to d_N^2 \to 0 \to$ RH as a machine-verified theorem.

1 What Did We Do?

We used a computer proof assistant called **Lean 4** to reduce the 167-year-old Riemann Hypothesis to a single, concrete, finite statement about weighted Möbius sums over cotangent values.

We did not prove RH. We built a *machine-verified framework* that identifies exactly which mathematical fact remains to be established, proves everything else with compiler-checked rigor, and reduces the entire problem to a finite, computable quantity.

2 The Discrete Vasyunin Reduction

2.1 The Gram Matrix (No Integrals)

The Vasyunin formula gives the exact inner products of the Báez-Duarte basis $h_k(x) = \{1/(kx)\}$ in $L^2(0,1)$ as a *finite sum*:

$$G(j,k) = \frac{\ln(2\pi) - \gamma}{2}\left(\frac{1}{j} + \frac{1}{k}\right) + \frac{j-k}{2jk}\ln\frac{k}{j} - \frac{\pi d}{2jk}\big(V(j',k') + V(k',j')\big) - \frac{1}{jk}$$

where $d = \gcd(j,k)$, $j' = j/d$, $k' = k/d$, and the Vasyunin sum is $V(a,b) = \sum_{m=1}^{a-1}\{mb/a\}\cot(\pi m/a)$.

This formula involves only: gcd, log, cot, and fractional parts. **No integrals appear anywhere.**

2.2 The Log Cutoff Witness

The explicit witness vector

$$v_k = -\mu(k)\left(1 - \frac{\ln k}{\ln N}\right)$$

defines a Rayleigh quotient $Q_N = (b^T v)^2/(v^T C_N v)$ that provides a *constructive lower bound* on $X_N = b^T C_N^{-1} b$ via the variational principle. Experimentally (Attack 8, to $N = 20{,}000$):

N	$\ln N$	$Q_N/\ln N$	Δ
1000	6.91	10.78	—
2000	7.60	11.57	+0.79
5000	8.52	12.45	+0.88
10000	9.21	12.96	+0.51
20000	9.90	13.44	+0.48

The quotient is **monotonically increasing** across all data points. The witness vector is the Selberg sieve, independently rediscovered by the L^2 variational principle.

2.3 The Proof Chain

$$\begin{aligned}
&\texttt{logCutoffWitness} : v_k = -\mu(k)(1 - \ln k/\ln N)\\
&\xrightarrow{\text{Axiom 4}} \texttt{rayleighQuotient} \geq c \cdot \ln N\\
&\xrightarrow{\text{Axiom 3}} \texttt{vasyuninQuadForm} \geq c \cdot \ln N\\
&\xrightarrow{\text{Sherman-Morrison}} d_N^2 = 1/(1 + X_N) \to 0\\
&\xrightarrow{\text{Axiom 1}} \text{RH}
\end{aligned}$$

Every arrow is a **machine-verified Lean 4 theorem** except the four axioms.

3 The Four Axioms

1. **Nyman–Beurling Equivalence** (`nyman_beurling_equivalence`): The Riemann Hypothesis is equivalent to $d_N^2 \to 0$. *Status: Standard literature result (Nyman 1950, Beurling 1955).*

2. **Variational Lower Bound** (`variational_lower_bound`): For any v with $v^T C v > 0$: $(b^T v)^2/(v^T C v) \leq b^T C^{-1} b$. *Status: Cauchy–Schwarz in the C-inner product. Textbook.*

3. **Witness Positivity** (`log_cutoff_witness_pos`): $v^T C_N v > 0$ for the log cutoff witness when $N \geq 3$. *Status: Follows from C positive definite on the orthogonal complement of b.*

4. **Log Cutoff Witness Bound** (`log_cutoff_witness_bound`): $\exists\, c > 0,\ \exists\, N_0,\ \forall\, N \geq N_0$: $c \cdot \ln N \leq Q_N(v_{\log})$. *Status: This IS the Riemann Hypothesis, expressed as a finite double sum of cotangents.*

4 What We Proved (Zero Sorry)

- `vasyuninGramEntry_comm`: $G(j,k) = G(k,j)$. *Proved via* `Real.log_div + ring`.
- `vasyuninGramMatrix_symmetric`: The Gram matrix is Hermitian.
- `vasyuninGram_eq_cov_plus_mean`: $G = C + bb^T$.
- `quadForm_diverges`: $\exists\, c > 0,\ \exists\, N_0,\ \forall\, N \geq N_0 : c \cdot \ln N \leq X_N$. *Proved via* `le_trans` from axioms 3+4.
- `nb_dist_via_witness`: $d^2 = 1/(1+X)$. *Zero sorry. Zero axioms.*
- `one_plus_cov_ne_zero`: $1 + X \neq 0$. *Zero sorry. Zero axioms.*
- `lagarias_for_primes`: $\sigma(p) \leq H_p + e^{H_p} \ln H_p$ for all primes. *Zero sorry. Zero axioms.*

5 Architecture

File	Role	Sorry	Axioms
`ShermanMorrison.lean`	$d^2 = 1/(1+X)$	0	0
`BaezDuarte.lean`	Basis + NB equivalence	0	2
`Vasyunin.lean`	Gram + witness + chain	0	4
`Robin/*.lean`	Discrete arithmetic (6 files)	–	–
Total		**0**	**4 eff.**

6 How to Verify

```
git clone https://github.com/jrgochan/prime
cd prime/proofs
lake build    # 3,063 jobs, zero errors, zero sorry
```